

Adoption of Fitness in Day to Day Life: Role of Mann Ki Baat - A Case Study

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ABSTRACT

“Mann Ki Baat” (MKB) is an initiative of the Prime Minister of India to connect with the common man on regular basis through radio and inform them about the initiatives of the Government. In addition, the Prime Minister seeks the support of the common man in nation building and governance. The purpose of this study was to find out the impact of “Mann Ki Baat” in creating greater awareness and motivation about fitness and making Fit India a mass movement. For the conduct of the study and collection of data a questionnaire carrying 8 questions was designed using Delphi method. The questionnaire was floated as part of a pan India survey to gather responses, which were later analyzed using different statistical techniques to reach the following conclusions:

- 1. Fit India is an idea which can play a pivotal role in taking India further in health and fitness aspects.*
- 2. The Mann Ki Baat Programme has promoted Fit India to be properly and scientifically executed, mainly focusing on the vulnerable groups such as children, women and people belonging to middle and low socio-economic strata in the country.*
- 3. The vision of a new India, a fitter India will be a reality only with a healthy individual, a healthy family and a healthy society.*

KEYWORDS: Mann Ki Baat, Fit India, Adoption of Fitness

INTRODUCTION

Need of Physical Activity: Current Status
“Globally, 27.5% people are “insufficiently physically active” and do not meet the WHO norms with women being less active than men, as reflected in a data from 168 countries covering 1.9 million people (The Lancet, 2018).

Physical inactivity damages health as much as obesity and smoking. It is the fourth leading risk factor (6%) for deaths globally and the leading cause for 21%–25% of breast and colon cancers, 27% of diabetes, and 30% cardiovascular diseases.

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The COVID-19 pandemic has taught a huge lesson to the humanity and people have started realizing the importance of fitness in their day-to-day life. The scenario is changing, but people are yet to be active enough worldwide. India is no different than world on fitness parameter. Some recent fitness facts are highlighted below:

- India ranks 8th in WHO study on physical activity among adolescents
- Less than 10% adults in the country follow the WHO recommended at least 150 minutes of moderate aerobic activity or 75 minutes of vigorous activity in a week.
- As per The Indian Council of Medical Research-India Diabetes (ICMR-INDIAB), women are far less active than men and only 3% women meet the minimum healthy levels of physical activity

However, over the past decade, there is a definite improvement in urban areas, where higher awareness has led more people to walk, run and participate in walkathons, marathons and cyclothons. The health benefits of these efforts are evident. A 2017 study from 15 states found diabetes and pre-diabetes in urban India has decreased with a rise in physical activity and healthier diets, but it is has increased among the urban poor and the rural rich, who haven't made the transition to a healthier lifestyle.

“It is a huge public health lever that is not being tapped. It has been

scientifically established that regular and sufficient physical activity improves weight control, muscular and cardiorespiratory fitness, bone and functional health, reduces the risk of falls and hip or vertebral fractures, hypertension, depression, coronary heart disease, stroke, diabetes and various types of cancers” – Shifalika Goenka, Professor at IIPH

Going forward, simply asking people to be more physically active will not be enough. The WHO's Global Action Plan on Physical Activity proposes solutions to strengthen leadership, governance, workforce capabilities, and advocacy to create a social movement to address this issue. It is essential to create a physical, social, and political environment that makes physical activity desirable, accessible and safe. It can be done with cross-sectoral collaboration between civic agencies, town planners, private companies, not-for-profit organizations, clubs and the community.

Fit India: Hum Fit toh India Fit

“Healthy man means healthy family which ultimately leads to healthy society. This is the only way to new India” – Sh. Narendra Modi, Prime Minister of India

With a view to make fitness an integral part of people's daily lives and encourage India to be healthier nation, the government of India has launched various schemes such as the Fit India and

Khelo India. The mission of the movement is to bring about behavioral changes among people and accept a more physically active lifestyle.

On 114th birth anniversary of Major Dhyani Chand, India's hockey legend, the country witnessed the launch of "Fit India Movement". In his speech, the Prime Minister (PM) emphasized the importance of a healthy lifestyle and how we have become ignorant about our fitness with the evolution of modern technology. He urged citizens to participate with enthusiasm in the movement, as the government only wishes to work as a catalyst and wants citizens to take it further and make it a huge success. He emphasized on the participation of every man and woman. Fit India proposes to undertake various initiatives and conduct events to achieve the following objectives:

- To promote fitness as easy, fun and free.
- To spread awareness on fitness and various physical activities that promotes fitness through focused campaigns.
- To encourage indigenous sports.
- To make fitness reach every school, college/university, panchayat /village, etc.
- To create a platform for citizens of India to share information, drive awareness and encourage sharing of personal fitness stories.

A month after the PM launched this

countrywide fitness movement; the University Grants Commission (UGC) released a set of guidelines for the higher educational institutes. The institutes are expected to incorporate a fitness period or time slot in the academic calendar. The provisions of healthcare and wellness initiatives should be considered among key objectives of the institutions.

Mann Ki Baat (MKB)-The Prime Minister's Show

Indian radio broadcasting has come a long way since 1923. Since Independence radio has played an instrumental role in building the roadmap of development. In the past two decades, it has re-emerged as a popular entertainment medium with introduction of FM channels across the country.

The Government uses this platform to connect with common people through the monthly radio programme - 'Mann Ki Baat', which is aired on Sundays. The prime minister can be heard on about 422 radio stations and relay centers by about 40-50 million listeners. The programme runs for 20-35 minutes and discusses the initiatives undertaken by the government and provides advice on addressing social issues. It has seen active involvement of large number of people from different spectrums of the country. The program has created enormous awareness among the citizens regarding various initiatives of the Government of India.

The utility of radio as a medium of

communication lies in its wide reach and penetration especially in remote areas. This is perhaps a deciding factor in choosing the radio programme format for this engagement and communication exercise. To increase the outreach of the Mann ki Baat program, it is made available in 23 different languages on TV and radio.

The large number of listeners and popularity of the programme across the world with international leaders participating in the program has led to multiple studies conducted on the programme. These include surveys on effectiveness and public perception of the programme, key word analysis for identification of common threads across the programmes, sentiment analysis of the PM across the programmes, role of the programme during COVID-19 pandemic etc. (Pandit, Pandya and Dhavan, 2021; Kaur and Mishra, 2021). These studies however have not examined the impact of “Mann Ki Baat” in creating greater awareness and motivation about fitness and making Fit India a mass movement. The present study aims to address this gap by closely looking at the available studies, programme guide and transcripts of the programme.

REVIEW OF LITERATURE

The “Mann Ki Baat” programme has gained attention of the researchers in various fields of study. Numerous

researchers have reviewed and analysed various issues like Clean India, Khadi Revolution, and Yoga and Ayurveda in various episodes of the programme.

Mehar studied MKB’s insights and its impact on the masses but did not examine which type of topic will become a part of the positive impact and discussion (Mehar, 2019). Berry has done a study on the radio for continuous engagement with the communities to educate them on developments in the Political Governance and Socio-Economic sphere of the country. However, in India, very few research studies have been done on public service broadcasting (M. Berry, 2011). Usha and Rodrigues mentioned little about the influence of Mann Ki Baat programme on people. The research elaborates about social media's effectiveness as a platform for continuous dialogue with citizens in modern politics and its implication for mainstream Media (Usha M. Rodrigues, 2017). A research study by Gyan indicated a positive relationship exists between vernacular radio programming content and community participation in issues of governance. The study recommended that radio station give more attention to such programs' content, but it does not mention what kind of content attracts the listeners (Gyan, 2018; Phadnis Ajit, 2019). A researcher provided a glimpse of how the MKB shows about the Government’s concern for the health and well-being of the

masses and its agenda to spread knowledge among people about the current scenario. MKB has served as a driving force communicating to the people about the Government's efforts for their welfare and enforcing the ideas shared and addressed in the show.

OBJECTIVES

This study has attempted to analyse the impact of 'Mann Ki Baat' programme, addressed by the Indian Prime Minister through All India Radio (AIR) and other media platforms. It aimed to explore the role played by the Mann Ki Baat programme in creating awareness and motivation about fitness. Additionally, the study also explored the impact of programme on making "Fit India" initiative of the Govt. of India a mass movement.

METHODS

Selection of Samples

The survey was conducted pan India including all the 28 states and 8UTs. For the ease of collection of the data cluster sampling method was implemented, wherein each state was considered as a cluster. The survey gathered responses of 9,520 subjects from all over the country, including both male and female from various spectrums such as:

- General Public
- Government Organisations
- Public Sector

- Corporate Houses
- Local Self Govt.
- Educational Institutions

Selection of tools

A questionnaire consisting of eight vital statements to meet the objectives of the study was developed through Delphi Method. It was translated into Hindi and pilot run on the students at Lakshmibai National College of Physical education, Thiruvananthapuram. Later, the questionnaire was converted into a digital format through Google form and circulated throughout the country through, LNCPE, STCs, NCOEs and various other training centers of Sports Authority of India.

Procedure

Both the soft copy and hard copy format of the questionnaire were supplied to the respondents. Responses received from different sources were compiled and the missing data and outliers were excluded. All the queries of the respondents related to the survey statements were made clear by the testers. It was ensured that the questionnaire has a face validity feature and collected only the required information.

RESULTS

3490 female (36.6%) and 6034 (63.4%) male respondents from various parts of the country participated in the survey.

A. Does Mann Ki Baat speech by PM of India inspire you?

Does MANN KI BAAT speech by PM of India inspire you ? क्या भारत के प्रधानमंत्री का मन की बात भाषण आपको प्रेरित करता है?
9,524 responses

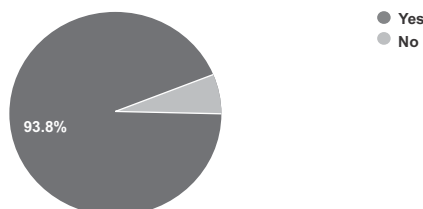


Figure 1: Response of the participants on “Does Mann Ki Baat speech by PM of India inspire you?”

93.8% believed that the Mann Ki Baat programme has inspired them to be a better individual. The Govt of India has brought various schemes like Khelo India, Fit India to motivate the youths of India to be more fit and healthy in order to materialize the dream of a healthy India.

The Prime minister of India has always promoted fitness and health in his Speech in Mann Ki Baat, which might have motivated the youths to be more actively contributing towards nation building process. The response of the participants is a testimonial to that.

B. Has MANN KI BAAT influenced you to participate in Fitness development program?

Has MANN KI BAAT influenced you to participate in Fitness development program? क्या मन की बात ने आपको फिटनेस विकास कार्यक्रम में भाग लेने के लिए प्रभावित किया है
9,524 responses

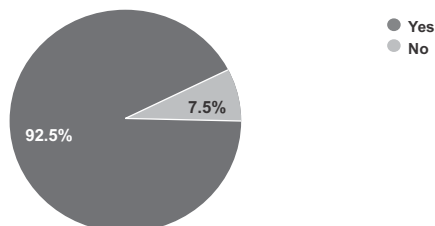


Figure 2: Response of the participants on “Has MANN KI BAAT influenced you to participate in Fitness development program?”

92.5% believed that the Mann Ki Baat programme has inspired them to be a physically fitter individual by influencing them to participate in regular physical activity of some kind. As most of the respondents belong to the youth category,

it is quite encouraging to see the youths of the country coming forward and realizing the importance of physical fitness. They have attributed this change in them to the Mann Ki Baat programme by our Honourable Prime Minister.

C. Have you ever been part of Fit India Movement?

Have you ever been part of Fit India Movement क्या आप कभी फिट इंडिया मूवमेंट का हिस्सा रहे हैं
9,524 responses

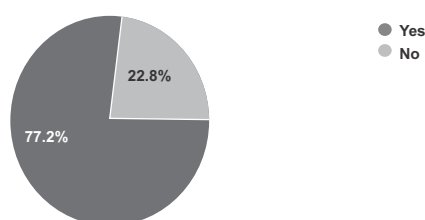


Figure 3: Response of the participants on “Have you ever been part of Fit India Movement?”

The mission of the Movement is to bring about behavioural changes and move towards a more physically active

lifestyle. The responses revealed that 77.2% of the participants have been a part of Fit India Movement.

D. Do you consider MANN KI BAAT as a platform for expression to enhance public participation in Fitness activities?

Out of the total number of respondents, 93.3% believed that the Mann Ki Baat programme has acted as a platform for

expression to enhance public participation in Fitness activities.

Do you consider MANN KI BAAT as a platform for expression to enhance public participation in Fitness activities? क्या आप मन की बात को फिटनेस गतिविध... बढ़ाने के लिए अभिव्यक्ति के मंच के रूप में मानते हैं?
9,524 responses

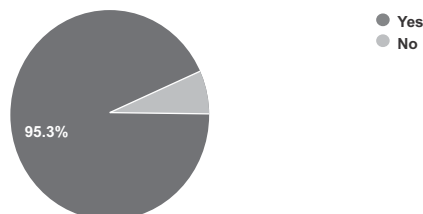


Figure 4: Response of the participants on Do you consider MANN KI BAAT as a platform for expression to enhance public participation in Fitness activities?

E. Do you believe that Fit India program is enabling building a healthy Nation?

Fit India movement has been instrumental in achieving the Prime Minister's aim of a healthy India. Out of the total number of respondents, 96.8% believed that the Fit India programme is

bringing a change in the fitness regime of the citizens of the country and India is moving towards becoming a healthier nation.

Do you believe that Fit India program is enabling building a healthy Nation ? क्या आपको लगता है कि फिट इंडिया कार्यक्रम स्वस्थ राष्ट्र का निर्माण करता है
9,524 responses



Figure 5: Response of the participants on Do you believe that Fit India program is enabling building a healthy Nation?

F. Has this MANN KI BAAT program created awareness in you about the need to stay Fit?

93.7% believed that the Mann Ki Baat programme has created awareness in them about the need to stay Fit and push them to indulge in regular physical activity. In his interaction with fitness enthusiasts from all over the country, the

Prime Minister said “Awareness and enthusiasm about health and fitness is constantly expanding in the country” and the outcome of this study supplements to the claim made by our honourable Prime Minister.

Has this MAAN KI BAAT program created an awareness in you about the need to stay Fit? क्या इस मन की बात कार्यक्रम ने फिट रहने की आवश्यकता के बारे में आपमें जागरूकता पैदा की है?
9,524 responses

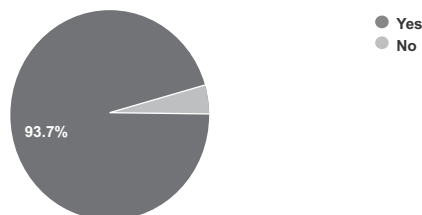


Figure 6: Response of the participants on “Has this MANN KI BAAT program created awareness in you about the need to stay Fit?”

G. Did the slogan “Fitness Ka Dose Aadha Ghanta Roz” motivated you in devoting time to participate in Physical Fitness activities?

‘Fitness dose for a day, half an hour everyday’ is a mantra which was introduced by the Prime Minister and he said the health and happiness of the people is hidden in this mantra. 92.7% believed that the fitness mantra introduced by the Prime Minister has

motivated them in devoting time to participate in physical fitness activity religiously. The research outcome revealed that the people have accepted “Fitness Mantra” by the Prime Minister and implemented that in their life to make themselves healthier.

Did the slogan “Fitness Ka Dose Aadha Ghanta Roz” motivated you in devoting time to participate in Physical Fitness activities? क्या “फिटनेस का डोज आधा ...भाग लेने के लिए समय समर्पित करने के लिए प्रेरित किया?
9,524 responses

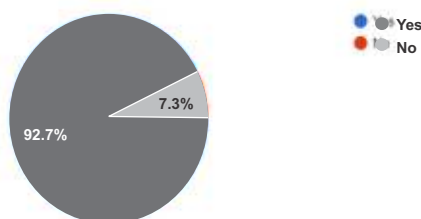


Figure 7: Response of the participants on “Did the slogan “Fitness Ka Dose Aadha Ghanta Roz” motivated you in devoting time to participate in Physical Fitness activities?”

H. Do you agree that Mann Ki Baat has contributed towards building a fitness culture in your surrounding?

93.5% believed that the Mann Ki Baat programme has contributed towards building a fitness culture in their surroundings. The very objective of Fit India movement was to bring a fitness

culture in India and the outcome of this study indicates that the citizens of India feel that the Fit India movement is inching closer towards attainment of that objective.

Do you agree that Mann Ki Baat has contributed towards building a fitness culture in your surrounding? क्या आप इस बात से सहमत हैं कि मन की बात...े आस-पास एक फिटनेस कल्चर बनाने में योगदान दिया है?
9,524 responses

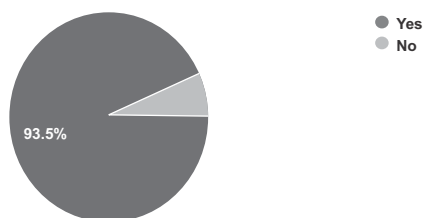


Figure 8: Response of the participants on Do you agree that Mann Ki Baat has contributed towards building a fitness culture in your surrounding?

The Prime Minister in his most of the talks in Mann Ki Baat has promoted Fit India and has been constantly pressing on the need of the fitness for every Indian.

DISCUSSION AND CONCLUSION

This study has attempted to analyse the impact of 'Mann Ki Baat' programme, addressed by the Indian Prime Minister through All India Radio (AIR) and other media platforms. It aimed to explore the role played by the Mann Ki Baat programme in creating awareness and motivation about fitness. Additionally, the study also explored the impact of programme on making "Fit India" initiative of the Govt. of India a mass movement.

India is a country with the largest youth population and most of the respondents of this survey belonged to the age group of 17-27. Seeing the youths being inspired by the PMs Mann Ki Baat programme can be a real turning point in drawing more youth towards the main stream and making an informed choice in contributing towards the nation building process. When the respondents were asked whether they have been inspired by the Mann Ki Baat Programme by the Prime Minister of India, then out of the total number of respondents, 93.8% believed that the Mann Ki Baat programme has inspired them to be a better individual. In the 90th episode of his monthly radio programme 'Mann Ki Baat', Prime Minister Modi said, "During

one's childhood, stories of the moon and stars in the sky attract everyone. For the youth, touching the sky is synonymous with making dreams come true...."The youth of the country has been the center of the talk in MKB most of the times, wherein the PM has always addressed various key issues related to youth and Sports and fitness being one among them.

Out of the total number of respondents, 92.5% believed that the Mann Ki Baat programme has inspired them to be a physically fitter individual by influencing them to participate in regular physical activity of some kind. As most of the respondents belong to the youth category, it is quite encouraging to see the youths of the country coming forward and realizing the importance of physical fitness. They have attributed this change in them to the Mann Ki Baat programme by our Honourable Prime minister. In 2016 the Active Healthy Kids Global Alliance organized the concurrent preparation of Report Cards on the physical activity of children and youth in 38 countries from 6 continents (representing 60% of the world's population). India fared pretty poorly in the worldwide survey. However, in 2022 the Indian report Card (IRC) in Physical activity among the adolescents and youth has shown an improvement in their grading to "c". Definitely the initiatives taken by the Govt. of India can be attributed to such improvements.

FIT INDIA Movement was launched

on 29th August, 2019 by Honourable Prime Minister with a view to make fitness an integral part of our daily lives. The mission of the Movement is to bring about behavioural changes and move towards a more physically active lifestyle. The participants were asked whether they have ever been a part of fit India movement in any way and the responses revealed that 77.2% of the participants have been a part of Fit India Movement. India is a country with second largest population in the world, the Government of India Fit India programme would be made available to all the citizens of India in the near future. Prime Minister during the launch of 'Fit India Movement' urged people to change their lifestyle and make fitness a daily routine. 'Fit India Movement' will be a very interesting campaign for everyone-children, the elderly, the young and women, and it is everyone's movement towards achieving a healthier life.

When the respondents were asked "Do you consider MANN KI BAAT as a platform for expression to enhance public participation in Fitness activities?", then out of the total number of respondents, 93.3% believed that the Mann Ki Baat programme has acted as a platform for expression to enhance public participation in Fitness activities.

Fit India movement has been instrumental in achieving the Prime Minister's aim of a healthy India. When the respondents were asked "Do you

believe that Fit India program is enabling building a healthy Nation ?", then out of the total number of respondents, 96.8% believed that the Fit India programme is bringing a change in the fitness regime of the citizens of the country and India is moving towards becoming a healthier nation.

In his interaction with fitness enthusiasts from all over the country, the Prime Minister said "Awareness and enthusiasm about health and fitness is constantly expanding in the country" and the outcome of this study supplements to the claim made by our honourable Prime Minister. When the respondents were asked "Has this MANN KI BAAT program created an awareness in you about the need to stay Fit?", then out of the total number of respondents, 93.7% believed that the Mann Ki Baat programme created an awareness in them about the need to stay Fit and push them to indulge in regular physical activity.

Fitness dose for a day, half an hour everyday' is a mantra which was introduced by the Prime Minister and he said the health and happiness of the people is hidden in this mantra. When the respondents were asked "Did the slogan "Fitness Ka Dose Aadha Ghanta Roz" motivated you in devoting time to participate in Physical Fitness activities?", then out of the total number of respondents, 92.7% believed that the fitness mantra introduced by the Prime Minister has motivated them in devoting

time to participate in physical fitness activity religiously. The research outcome revealed that the people have accepted “Fitness Mantra” by the Prime Minister and implemented that in their life to make themselves healthier.

Working out has become increasingly popular, and it has created new opportunities for entrepreneurs in the country which resulted in development and growth of fitness industry that made pursuit of fitness an integral part of Indian lifestyle. The Fit India Movement is necessary for increasing the awareness of the need for a healthy life among every citizen of India. The happiness and wellbeing of an individual is very closely linked with his physical health and fitness. When the respondents were asked “Do you agree that Mann Ki Baat has contributed

towards building a fitness culture in your surrounding?”, then out of the total number of respondents, 93.5% believed that the Mann ki Baat programme has contributed towards building a fitness culture in their surroundings. The very objective of Fit India movement was to bring a fitness culture in India and the outcome of this study indicates that the citizens of India feel that the Fit India movement is inching closer towards attainment of that objective.

Today lifestyle diseases are on a rise in India affecting even the young children. But small lifestyle changes can prevent these lifestyle diseases. ‘Fit India Movement’ is an effort to bring these small lifestyle changes. Fit India is an idea which can play a pivotal role in taking India further in health and Fitness aspects.

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